On October 23, 1951, we were finally finished with the manuscript of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism after just over a year of fairly hard and unremitting labor. I judged its length to be something over 300,000 words, of which I had written a third. On that day, we sent it off to Williams & Wilkins by Air Express.

On October 29, I had the galleys to David Starr: Space Ranger and I had finished a 10,000-word novelette called "Youth/' which only took me ten days. About the only bad news about writing that month was the return of the first third of The Currents of Space from Brad. He found me overwriting in spots again and wanted certain changes.

Meanwhile, I had heard from Scott Feldman again, the friend of my bachelor days. A surprising sea change had overtaken him. His kindness to Wodehouse in wartime internment was not forgotten by that gentleman.

After the war, Wodehouse came to the United States and never returned to Great Britain (although the bitterness against him died down and he was eventually knighted by Elizabeth II). In the United States, he offered, in gratitude, to let Scott serve as his agent. Scott eventually changed his last name to Meredith and, beginning with Wodehouse, founded what is perhaps the most successful literary agency in the United States.

Now Scott wrote me. Apparently he was of the opinion that Fred Pohl's literary agency was on the point of failure and he suggested that

1 become a client of the Scott Meredith agency.

It might well have been to my financial benefit to do so, but there was no way I could let Fred down just because he was having a hard

2 See Nightfall and Other Stories.

time. Besides, if Fred left the agency business I intended to have no agent at all thereafter. I replied politely to Scott and refused.

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David filled our lives. We watched eagerly for all signs of development. On October 7, when he was forty-eight days old, he smiled for the first time, and had been able to follow our moving fingers with his eyes some days before that. On October 11, he consumed his first solid food.